

Approved Open-Source Software (OSS) Licensing Policy

Author: Corporate Legal Counsel	Target Audience: Engineering Leaders & Architects	Compliance Target: IP Protection & Exit Diligence
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1.0 Purpose & Valuation Risk Management

The market value of a B2B SaaS enterprise is derived directly from its exclusive, proprietary ownership of its core source code. The injection of copyleft open-source licenses legally forces the enterprise to release its proprietary algorithms under open terms, effectively destroying the underlying asset's enterprise value. This policy defines strict boundaries for code inclusion.

2.0 Permitted vs. Prohibited Licenses

Section 1.2 Permissive Open-Source Licensing

Engineering teams are fully authorized to integrate external packages governed by permissive models—specifically **MIT**, **Apache 2.0**, and **BSD**—into production repositories without undergoing case-by-case architectural reviews, provided that copyright credits are correctly preserved in deployment packages.

Section 1.5 Strict Prohibition of Copyleft Constructs

Under no circumstances may any developer copy, paste, or link code modules governed by **GNU General Public License versions 1, 2, or 3 (GPLv1, GPLv2, GPLv3)**, **AGPL**, or **LGPL** into proprietary code repositories. Integration of copyleft mechanisms creates an instant legal contamination vector, forcing clean-room engineering before any liquidity event can occur.

Section 1.6 Continuous CI/CD Automated Verification

All code branches must execute automated Software Composition Analysis (SCA) scans prior to code integration. If a dependency or inline comment block indicates a copyleft origin, the build pipeline must automatically terminate and trigger a high-priority remediation ticket.

VALUATION RECOVERY ACTION: If copyleft contamination is discovered, code modules must be decoupled immediately. The algorithm must be rewritten from first principles via clean-room design protocols to preserve intellectual property boundaries.

